

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« Physically, I'm probably one of the strongest ones, so maybe it would benefit me. But I think I'm not ready to play five sets. » – World No. 1 tennis star Aryna Sabalenka on whether she'd want the women's game to turn to best-of-five set matches »



« It's going to be an interesting time to see if there's another player or two who can break in with those two. » – Tennis legend John McEnroe feels the arrival of a third young contender could take the Carlos Alcaraz-Jannik Sinner rivalry to even greater heights »

\$10 billion

The Buss family has agreed to sell a majority stake in the Los Angeles Lakers to TWG Global CEO Mark Walter, while confirming that Jeanie Buss (**in pic**) will remain governor of the storied NBA franchise. Financial terms of the deal were not disclosed, but initial reports stated that the agreement valued the 17-time NBA champion Lakers at USD 10 billion — marking the largest-ever sale of a professional sports team. Walter, who holds ownership interests in

several professional sports franchises, including MLB's Los Angeles Dodgers and the WNBA's Los Angeles Sparks, has been a minority owner of the Lakers since 2021.



9.75s

Paris Olympics silver medallist Kishane Thompson clocked 9.75s at the Jamaican national athletics trials to win gold, becoming the sixth-fastest 100m sprinter in history. Meanwhile, three-time Olympic and 10-time world champion Shelly-Ann Fraser-Pryce punched her ticket to a ninth World Championships with a third-place finish in the 100m in the same trials, clocking 10.91secs.

SO NEAR, YET SO FAR



Three-time Olympic champion Faith Kipyegon failed in her bid to become the first woman to run a mile in under four minutes. Kipyegon, the Olympic 1,500-metre gold medallist from Kenya, ran in 4 minutes, 06.42 seconds — the fastest mile in history by a woman — at Stade Charléty in Paris. Her time was better than her world record of 4:07.64, but won't be recognised by the international federation because the Nike-sponsored event dubbed "Breaking4: Faith Kipyegon vs. the 4-Minute Mile" was unofficial. AFP